decide what it is. Is it resolved to enforce law and order on Arabs and Jews alike? Or is it a fig leaf for the hilltop youth, who do as they please in the territories? That same question also applies to the army which has thus far failed to deal effectively with either Palestinian terrorism or Jewish terrorism." Barnea's words are courageous, but this government is a settler government and its decisions will be settler decisions. The only good decision it can take is to resign and call for new elections!

Could Avi Maoz's resignation today be the first swallow announcing the spring? Probably not, as he musters one voice only and will go on supporting the coalition in the Knesset. But if Netanyahu respects the Aqaba decisions, then Smotrich and Ben-Gvir will go. That would be the end of the coalition. But our Houdini may well convince the US that he is all in favor of the de-escalation decisions, while proving to his two acolytes that he is actively pushing new settlements.

In 1928, Arthur Ruppin, the most pacific of peaceful German Zionists, the founder of Brit Shalom, which I already mentioned, wrote to the like-minded Hans Kohn:

> There is no parallel in history to the aim of Zionism to settle the Jews peaceably in a country which is already inhabited. Such an entry by one nation into the country of another is known in history only by means of conquest; so far, no nation has ever been willing to tolerate another nation settling beside it and claiming complete equality and national autonomy … The Brit Shalom was to become the forum to consider and discuss the problem.

As I mentioned, Ruppin abandoned the dream of such a peaceable coexistence after the massacre of tens of Jews in Hebron and other places by Palestinians, in 1929.

Tuesday, February 28

Today, Likud Defense Minister Gallant declared that he opposed the calls for disobedience in the army: one should not use the army for one side or